

IF IT'S TO BE, IT'S UP TO ME

I was blessed with a great mother who poured into me. She never let me overlook opportunities, and she always stressed how much potential I had in school, sports, and business. She was also a huge proponent of personal responsibility. She taught me from an early age that I was ultimately responsible for my wins and losses. One of her favorite sayings was, “If it’s to be, it’s up to me.” I heard that at least once a week growing up. It was her fallback statement whenever my brother or I felt like whining about whatever trouble we were facing at the time. She didn’t have time for our little pity parties, and she didn’t want us to make time for them, either.

When I was in high school, Mama Hogan made a cross-stitch of that quote and encouraged me to keep it with me throughout high school, college, and into my adult life. It was her little reminder that, wherever I was and whatever I was doing, no one was going to hand me anything. If I wanted to accomplish something, it was my responsibility to make it happen. Sitting in our little Kentucky home, she’d say, “Chris, you’re bigger than this town.” Now, there is absolutely nothing wrong with my hometown; it’s a great place to live with great people. But my mother was teaching me to think bigger. She wanted me to believe that I could go anywhere and do anything I put my mind to. She believed in me and in my ability to become successful, and she made me believe that for myself. My mom filled me with these messages throughout my entire life, so that’s the mind-set I have now toward every goal I want to accomplish.

As I’m typing this in my home office right now, the little framed cross-stitch she made thirty years ago is prominently displayed on the bookshelf right beside me. It’s a constant reminder of the millionaire mind-set of a single mom in middle-class Kentucky. *If it’s to be, it’s up to me.* It’s a lesson I learned early on and one I still believe to this day. And, more importantly, it’s a characteristic of every millionaire I’ve ever met. If you want to bust